but a way of maintaining political control over production of knowledge and social discourse.[29] While colonial education was offered as a means to climb the social ladder with acceptance by the European being its ultimate destination, there were glass ceilings firmly in place which ensured that native students were always kept below the European.[30]

Colonial curriculum was often imported from either Britain or North America, and was designed to produce Africans who would always consider themselves inferior in their interactions with Europeans, and would take pride in serving the interests of the White man. It was formulated to prepare native children for taking up subordinate roles and to protect the interests of the coloniser at the expense of those of the colonised community.[31] Impressionable young Africans were being taught that a 'civilised' African was one who assimilated into European culture. Even teachers were trained in such a manner so as to ensure that African and European children in British colonies did not receive the same education.[32] The entire stated goal of colonial education was to preserve and maintain the 'unquestioned superiority and supremacy' of the Whites, which has been summarised by scholars as follows:

> The brown workman would always have to work under a European and therefore there would be no conflict. The cast of mind of the Native is such that he could rarely take charge. His lack of inventiveness and of ingenuity in mechanical work would make him inferior to the European as a trained workman, and at no time would he compete with the European.[33]

One 'scientific' reason that was offered to explain the disparity in curricula was the coloniser's perception of a given colonised community's aptitude for knowledge based on race, the pecking order being Whites, Indians, Coloureds and Black Africans.[34] The premise of this racial stratification was that Africans could not master 'bookish subjects' and therefore, even if given an opportunity, were incapable of competing with Europeans. Accordingly, they were offered only vocational or industrial training. On the rare occasion that 'exceptional' African students were offered access to an 'academic curriculum', the medium of instruction was English, proficiency in which was integral to academic success.[35] That said, even the academic curriculum would be centred on Europe and North America,